Guitar Exercises - Section IX, Level 69

A melodic minor construction, raised sixth and seventh control, tonic colors, and new chord harmony

FIXED KEY: A | 10 MODULES | 640 TONES

Section IX begins by changing the upper half of A natural minor. Harmonic minor raised only the seventh; melodic minor raises both the sixth and seventh. The result removes the augmented second, strengthens the leading tone, creates a major IV chord, and introduces a new seventh-chord family.

1. Hear the three minor forms

Natural, harmonic, and melodic minor differ only in degrees 6 and 7. Compare them before learning new fretboard geometry.

2. Control F/F# and G/G#

The raised sixth and raised seventh must be deliberate. Do not let the direction of the line choose them automatically.

3. Hear the new harmony

Melodic minor creates Bm7, D7, F#m7b5, and G#m7b5 while retaining AmMaj7, Cmaj7#5, and E7.

Three A-minor pitch collections

```
A NATURAL MINOR    A  B  C  D  E  F  G   A
Degrees            1  2  b3 4  5  b6 b7  1

A HARMONIC MINOR   A  B  C  D  E  F  G#  A
Degrees            1  2  b3 4  5  b6 7   1

A MELODIC MINOR    A  B  C  D  E  F# G#  A
Degrees            1  2  b3 4  5  6  7   1

UPPER TETRACHORDS
Natural:  E-F-G-A       5-b6-b7-1
Harmonic: E-F-G#-A      5-b6-7-1
Melodic:  E-F#-G#-A     5-6-7-1
```

Written workload

Module	Tones
A - three forms	72
B - octave routes	78
C - raised 6	48
D - raised 7	36
E - direction options	48
F - triads	56
G - sevenths	70
H - tonic colors	32
I - progressions	80
J - model/capstone	120
TOTAL	640

Two directional conventions

Symmetric or modern/jazz melodic minor uses A-B-C-D-E-F#-G# in both directions. Classical melodic minor commonly ascends with F# and G# but descends as natural minor with G and F. This workbook trains both choices and labels them explicitly.

RULE Choose the descending form for a musical reason; do not switch by accident.

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Scale-family atlas, harmonized chords, and functional changes

RAISED 6 = F# | RAISED 7 = G#

ONE SCALE CHANGE REBUILDS THE IV CHORD AND THE UPPER MINOR HARMONY

Form	Degrees	Upper four notes	Primary sound
Natural minor	1 2 b3 4 5 b6 b7	E F G A	modal / softer dominant
Harmonic minor	1 2 b3 4 5 b6 7	E F G# A	augmented second; strong V
Melodic minor	1 2 b3 4 5 6 7	E F# G# A	smooth leading-tone ascent

Melodic-minor triads

Degree	Chord	Spelling
i	Am	A-C-E
ii	Bm	B-D-F#
III+	Caug	C-E-G#
IV	D	D-F#-A
V	E	E-G#-B
vi dim	F#dim	F#-A-C
vii dim	G#dim	G#-B-D

Melodic-minor seventh chords

Degree	Chord	Spelling
iMaj7	AmMaj7	A-C-E-G#
ii7	Bm7	B-D-F#-A
IIImaj7#5	Cmaj7#5	C-E-G#-B
IV7	D7	D-F#-A-C
V7	E7	E-G#-B-D
vi half-dim	F#m7b5	F#-A-C-E
vii half-dim	G#m7b5	G#-B-D-F#

What changed from harmonic minor?

Degree	Harmonic-minor chord	Melodic-minor chord	Reason
ii	Bdim / Bm7b5	Bm / Bm7	F becomes F#
iv	Dm / Dm7	D / D7	F becomes F#
vi	F / Fmaj7	F#dim / F#m7b5	new root on raised degree 6

FUNCTION The major IV chord D and the minor ii chord Bm are among the clearest new melodic-minor sounds.

Standard tuning. Fixed key: A melodic minor. Classical and symmetric descending options are labeled separately.

Guitar Exercises - Section IX, Level 69

Module A - natural, harmonic, and melodic upper tetrachords

6 STRINGS | 72 TONES

PLAY E-F-G-A, THEN E-F-G#-A, THEN E-F#-G#-A

Each string compares the same tonic approach three ways. Keep the rhythm, articulation, and final A identical so the ear judges only degrees 6 and 7.

Low E

```
NATURAL
Nte|E----F----G----A----|
Deg|5----b6---b7---1----|
  E|12---13---15---17---|

HARMONIC
Nte|E----F----G#---A----|
Deg|5----b6---7----1----|
  E|12---13---16---17---|

MELODIC
Nte|E----F#---G#---A----|
Deg|5----6----7----1----|
  E|12---14---16---17---|
```

A string

```
NATURAL
Nte|E----F----G----A----|
Deg|5----b6---b7---1----|
  A|7----8----10---12---|

HARMONIC
Nte|E----F----G#---A----|
Deg|5----b6---7----1----|
  A|7----8----11---12---|

MELODIC
Nte|E----F#---G#---A----|
Deg|5----6----7----1----|
  A|7----9----11---12---|
```

D string

```
NATURAL
Nte|E----F----G----A----|
Deg|5----b6---b7---1----|
  D|2----3----5----7----|

HARMONIC
Nte|E----F----G#---A----|
Deg|5----b6---7----1----|
  D|2----3----6----7----|

MELODIC
Nte|E----F#---G#---A----|
Deg|5----6----7----1----|
  D|2----4----6----7----|
```

G string

```
NATURAL
Nte|E----F----G----A----|
Deg|5----b6---b7---1----|
  G|9----10---12---14---|

HARMONIC
Nte|E----F----G#---A----|
Deg|5----b6---7----1----|
  G|9----10---13---14---|

MELODIC
Nte|E----F#---G#---A----|
Deg|5----6----7----1----|
  G|9----11---13---14---|
```

B string

```
NATURAL
Nte|E----F----G----A----|
Deg|5----b6---b7---1----|
  B|5----6----8----10---|

HARMONIC
Nte|E----F----G#---A----|
Deg|5----b6---7----1----|
  B|5----6----9----10---|

MELODIC
Nte|E----F#---G#---A----|
Deg|5----6----7----1----|
  B|5----7----9----10---|
```

High e

```
NATURAL
Nte|E----F----G----A----|
Deg|5----b6---b7---1----|
  e|12---13---15---17---|

HARMONIC
Nte|E----F----G#---A----|
Deg|5----b6---7----1----|
  e|12---13---16---17---|

MELODIC
Nte|E----F#---G#---A----|
Deg|5----6----7----1----|
  e|12---14---16---17---|
```

Failure signs

F# is used in the harmonic-minor pass; G natural leaks into the melodic-minor pass; or the final A arrives at a different time. Repair one string at half tempo and speak the degrees.

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Module B - octave routes and two-octave melodic-minor mirror

3 ONE-OCTAVE ROUTES | 1 TWO-OCTAVE ROUTE | 78 TONES

RE-ATTACK THE UPPER TONIC BEFORE THE EXACT REVERSE

The one-octave routes are the reference for both symmetric and classical descending practice. The two-octave route begins on low-E fret 5 and reaches B-string fret 10.

Open-position octave

8 up | 8 down | 16 tones

```
Nte|A---B---C---D---E---F#--G#--A---|A---G#--F#--E---D---C---B---A---
Deg|1---2---b3--4---5---6---7---1---|1---7---6---5---4---b3--2---1---
  e|-------------------------------|-------------------------------
  B|-------------------------------|-------------------------------
  G|-----------------------1---2---|2---1---------------------------
  D|-----------0---2---4-----------|-------4---2---0---------------
  A|0---2---3-----------------------|-------------------3---2---0---
  E|-------------------------------|-------------------------------
```

Fifth-position octave

8 up | 8 down | 16 tones

```
Nte|A---B---C---D---E---F#--G#--A---|A---G#--F#--E---D---C---B---A---
Deg|1---2---b3--4---5---6---7---1---|1---7---6---5---4---b3--2---1---
  e|-------------------------------|-------------------------------
  B|-------------------------------|-------------------------------
  G|-------------------------------|-------------------------------
  D|-----------------------6---7---|7---6---------------------------
  A|-----------5---7---9-----------|-------9---7---5---------------
  E|5---7---8-----------------------|-------------------8---7---5---
```

Twelfth-position octave

8 up | 8 down | 16 tones

```
Nte|A---B---C---D---E---F#--G#--A---|A---G#--F#--E---D---C---B---A---
Deg|1---2---b3--4---5---6---7---1---|1---7---6---5---4---b3--2---1---
  e|-------------------------------|-------------------------------
  B|-------------------------------|-------------------------------
  G|-----------------------13--14--|14--13-------------------------
  D|-----------12--14--16----------|--------16--14--12-------------
  A|12--14--15----------------------|-------------------15--14--12--
  E|-------------------------------|-------------------------------
```

Two-octave route - low E5 to B10 and exact reverse

```
Nte|A--B--C--D--E--F#-G#-A--B--C--D--E--F#-G#-A--|A--G#-F#-E--D--C--B--A--G#-F#-E--D--C--B--A--
Deg|1--2--b3-4--5--6--7--1--2--b3-4--5--6--7--1--|1--7--6--5--4--b3-2--1--7--6--5--4--b3-2--1--
  e|-----------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------
  B|---------------------------------------9--10-|10-9-------------------------------------------
  G|------------------------------7--9--11-------|------11-9--7-----------------------------------
  D|-----------------6--7--9--10----------------|--------------10-9--7--6-------------------------
  A|---------5--7--9-----------------------------|----------------------------9--7--5-------------
  E|5--7--8--------------------------------------|---------------------------------8--7--5--
```

PICKING Thirty tones are even. Repeat with D-start and U-start; do not reset at the upper A.

Guitar Exercises - Section IX, Level 69

Module E - symmetric and classical descending options

3 REGISTERS | 48 WRITTEN TONES

ASCEND WITH F# AND G#; CHOOSE THE DESCENT CONVENTION EXPLICITLY

The symmetric option reverses the melodic-minor ascent from Module B. The classical option descends through A natural minor: A-G-F-E-D-C-B-A. The printed cells below pair the melodic ascent with the natural-minor descent.

OPEN REGISTER - melodic ascent | natural-minor descent

Classical directional form. For symmetric form, reverse the first eight notes instead.

```
Nte|A---B---C---D---E---F#--G#--A---|A---G---F---E---D---C---B---A---
Deg|1---2---b3--4---5---6---7---1---|1---b7--b6--5---4---b3--2---1---
  e|---------------------------------|---------------------------------
  B|---------------------------------|---------------------------------
  G|-------------------------1---2---|2---0---------------------------
  D|------------0---2---4-----------|--------3---2---0---------------
  A|0---2---3-----------------------|-------------------3---2---0---
  E|---------------------------------|---------------------------------
```

FIFTH REGISTER - melodic ascent | natural-minor descent

Classical directional form. For symmetric form, reverse the first eight notes instead.

```
Nte|A---B---C---D---E---F#--G#--A---|A---G---F---E---D---C---B---A---
Deg|1---2---b3--4---5---6---7---1---|1---b7--b6--5---4---b3--2---1---
  e|---------------------------------|---------------------------------
  B|---------------------------------|---------------------------------
  G|---------------------------------|---------------------------------
  D|-------------------------6---7---|7---5---------------------------
  A|------------5---7---9-----------|--------8---7---5---------------
  E|5---7---8-----------------------|-------------------8---7---5---
```

TWELFTH REGISTER - melodic ascent | natural-minor descent

Classical directional form. For symmetric form, reverse the first eight notes instead.

```
Nte|A---B---C---D---E---F#--G#--A---|A---G---F---E---D---C---B---A---
Deg|1---2---b3--4---5---6---7---1---|1---b7--b6--5---4---b3--2---1---
  e|---------------------------------|---------------------------------
  B|---------------------------------|---------------------------------
  G|-------------------------13--14--|14--12--------------------------
  D|------------12--14--16----------|--------15--14--12--------------
  A|12--14--15----------------------|-------------------15--14--12--
  E|---------------------------------|---------------------------------
```

Guitar Exercises - Section IX, Level 69

Module C - raised-sixth control: F, F#, G#, A

6 STRINGS | 48 TONES

b6-6-7-1-7-6-b6-1

The cell separates natural-minor F from melodic-minor F#. F# must lead smoothly to G#, while F remains a contrasting borrowed or directional color.

Low E

Natural color -> melodic ascent -> natural comparison -> tonic.

```
Nte|F----F#---G#---A----G#---F#---F----A----
Deg|b6---6----7----1----7----6----b6---1----
  e|-----------------------------------------
  B|-----------------------------------------
  G|-----------------------------------------
  D|-----------------------------------------
  A|-----------------------------------------
  E|13---14---16---17---16---14---13---17---
```

A string

Natural color -> melodic ascent -> natural comparison -> tonic.

```
Nte|F----F#---G#---A----G#---F#---F----A----
Deg|b6---6----7----1----7----6----b6---1----
  e|-----------------------------------------
  B|-----------------------------------------
  G|-----------------------------------------
  D|-----------------------------------------
  A|8----9----11---12---11---9----8----12---
  E|-----------------------------------------
```

D string

Natural color -> melodic ascent -> natural comparison -> tonic.

```
Nte|F----F#---G#---A----G#---F#---F----A----
Deg|b6---6----7----1----7----6----b6---1----
  e|-----------------------------------------
  B|-----------------------------------------
  G|-----------------------------------------
  D|3----4----6----7----6----4----3----7----
  A|-----------------------------------------
  E|-----------------------------------------
```

G string

Natural color -> melodic ascent -> natural comparison -> tonic.

```
Nte|F----F#---G#---A----G#---F#---F----A----
Deg|b6---6----7----1----7----6----b6---1----
  e|-----------------------------------------
  B|-----------------------------------------
  G|10---11---13---14---13---11---10---14---
  D|-----------------------------------------
  A|-----------------------------------------
  E|-----------------------------------------
```

B string

Natural color -> melodic ascent -> natural comparison -> tonic.

```
Nte|F----F#---G#---A----G#---F#---F----A----
Deg|b6---6----7----1----7----6----b6---1----
  e|-----------------------------------------
  B|6----7----9----10---9----7----6----10---
  G|-----------------------------------------
  D|-----------------------------------------
  A|-----------------------------------------
  E|-----------------------------------------
```

High e

Natural color -> melodic ascent -> natural comparison -> tonic.

```
Nte|F----F#---G#---A----G#---F#---F----A----
Deg|b6---6----7----1----7----6----b6---1----
  e|13---14---16---17---16---14---13---17---
  B|-----------------------------------------
  G|-----------------------------------------
  D|-----------------------------------------
  A|-----------------------------------------
  E|-----------------------------------------
```

Ear test

Over an A drone, compare F-A, F#-A, and F#-G#-A. F# should sound like a brighter sixth, not like an accidental chromatic passing tone.

Guitar Exercises - Section IX, Level 69

Module D - raised-seventh control: G, G#, A

6 STRINGS | 36 TONES

b7-7-1-7-b7-1

Natural-minor G and melodic-minor G# are one fret apart but have different jobs. G is a subtonic color; G# is the leading tone and the third of E7.

Low E

Compare subtonic, leading tone, and tonic resolution.

```
Nte|G-----G#----A-----G#----G-----A-----
Deg|b7----7-----1-----7-----b7----1-----
  e|-----------------------------------
  B|-----------------------------------
  G|-----------------------------------
  D|-----------------------------------
  A|-----------------------------------
  E|15----16----17----16----15----17----
```

A string

Compare subtonic, leading tone, and tonic resolution.

```
Nte|G-----G#----A-----G#----G-----A-----
Deg|b7----7-----1-----7-----b7----1-----
  e|-----------------------------------
  B|-----------------------------------
  G|-----------------------------------
  D|-----------------------------------
  A|10----11----12----11----10----12----
  E|-----------------------------------
```

D string

Compare subtonic, leading tone, and tonic resolution.

```
Nte|G-----G#----A-----G#----G-----A-----
Deg|b7----7-----1-----7-----b7----1-----
  e|-----------------------------------
  B|-----------------------------------
  G|-----------------------------------
  D|5-----6-----7-----6-----5-----7-----
  A|-----------------------------------
  E|-----------------------------------
```

G string

Compare subtonic, leading tone, and tonic resolution.

```
Nte|G-----G#----A-----G#----G-----A-----
Deg|b7----7-----1-----7-----b7----1-----
  e|-----------------------------------
  B|-----------------------------------
  G|12----13----14----13----12----14----
  D|-----------------------------------
  A|-----------------------------------
  E|-----------------------------------
```

B string

Compare subtonic, leading tone, and tonic resolution.

```
Nte|G-----G#----A-----G#----G-----A-----
Deg|b7----7-----1-----7-----b7----1-----
  e|-----------------------------------
  B|8-----9-----10----9-----8-----10----
  G|-----------------------------------
  D|-----------------------------------
  A|-----------------------------------
  E|-----------------------------------
```

High e

Compare subtonic, leading tone, and tonic resolution.

```
Nte|G-----G#----A-----G#----G-----A-----
Deg|b7----7-----1-----7-----b7----1-----
  e|15----16----17----16----15----17----
  B|-----------------------------------
  G|-----------------------------------
  D|-----------------------------------
  A|-----------------------------------
  E|-----------------------------------
```

Function test

Play G# over E7, then resolve to A. Play G over Am7 or a natural-minor phrase. The note choice should follow the harmony or the directional convention, not habit.

Guitar Exercises - Section IX, Level 69

Module H - A-minor tonic colors: triad, major seventh, sixth, and 6/9

4 CELLS | 32 TONES

THE TONIC REMAINS MINOR; THE UPPER COLOR CHANGES

All four cells retain A, C, and E. G# creates AmMaj7, F# creates Am6, and the combination of B and F# suggests Am6/9 color. Sustain each cell over an A drone.

Am triad

A-C-E-A-A-E-C-A

```
Nte|A----C----E----A----|A----E----C----A----
Deg|1----b3---5----1----|1----5----b3---1----
  e|---------------------|---------------------
  B|---------------------|---------------------
  G|---------------------|---------------------
  D|--------------7----|7--------------------
  A|----------7---------|-----7--------------
  E|5----8--------------|----------8----5----
```

LISTEN Do the upper tones sound stable, tense, or open over the tonic?

AmMaj7

A-C-E-G#-A-G#-E-A

```
Nte|A----C----E----G#---|A----G#---E----A----
Deg|1----b3---5----7----|1----7----5----1----
  e|---------------------|---------------------
  B|---------------------|---------------------
  G|---------------------|---------------------
  D|--------------6----|7----6--------------
  A|----------7---------|----------7---------
  E|5----8--------------|---------------5----
```

LISTEN Do the upper tones sound stable, tense, or open over the tonic?

Am6

A-C-E-F#-A-F#-E-A

```
Nte|A----C----E----F#---|A----F#---E----A----
Deg|1----b3---5----6----|1----6----5----1----
  e|---------------------|---------------------
  B|---------------------|---------------------
  G|---------------------|---------------------
  D|--------------4----|7----4--------------
  A|----------7---------|---------7---------
  E|5----8--------------|---------------5----
```

LISTEN Do the upper tones sound stable, tense, or open over the tonic?

Am6/9 color

A-B-C-E-F#-E-C-A

```
Nte|A----B----C----E----|F#---E----C----A----
Deg|1----2----b3---5----|6----5----b3---1----
  e|---------------------|---------------------
  B|---------------------|---------------------
  G|---------------------|---------------------
  D|---------------------|---------------------
  A|--------------7----|9----7--------------
  E|5----7----8---------|----------8----5----
```

LISTEN Do the upper tones sound stable, tense, or open over the tonic?

Guitar Exercises - Section IX, Level 69

Module F - harmonized melodic-minor triad arpeggios

7 TRIADS | 56 TONES

THE RAISED SIXTH CREATES Bm, D MAJOR, AND F#dim

Every cell ascends root-third-fifth-octave, repeats the top root, and reverses. Say the Roman numeral and quality before playing.

i - Am

A-C-E

```
Nte|A----C----E----A----A----E----C----A----
Deg|1----b3---5----1----1----5----b3---1----
  e|-----------------------------------------
  B|-----------------------------------------
  G|-----------------------------------------
  D|--------------7----7--------------------
  A|----------7-------------7----------------
  E|5----8-----------------------8----5----
```

ii - Bm

B-D-F#

```
Nte|B----D----F#---B----B----F#---D----B----
Deg|2----4----6----2----2----6----4----2----
  e|-----------------------------------------
  B|-----------------------------------------
  G|-----------------------------------------
  D|--------------9----9--------------------
  A|----------9-------------9----------------
  E|7----10----------------------10---7----
```

III+ - Caug

C-E-G#

```
Nte|C----E----G#---C----C----G#---E----C----
Deg|b3---5----7----b3---b3---7----5----b3---
  e|-----------------------------------------
  B|-----------------------------------------
  G|--------------5----5--------------------
  D|----------6-------------6----------------
  A|-----7-------------------------7---------
  E|8--------------------------------8----
```

IV - D

D-F#-A

```
Nte|D----F#---A----D----D----A----F#---D----
Deg|4----6----1----4----4----1----6----4----
  e|-----------------------------------------
  B|-----------------------------------------
  G|--------------7----7--------------------
  D|----------7-------------7----------------
  A|5----9-----------------------9----5----
  E|-----------------------------------------
```

V - E

E-G#-B

```
Nte|E----G#---B----E----E----B----G#---E----
Deg|5----7----2----5----5----2----7----5----
  e|-----------------------------------------
  B|--------------5----5--------------------
  G|----------4-------------4----------------
  D|-----6-------------------------6---------
  A|7--------------------------------7----
  E|-----------------------------------------
```

vi dim - F#dim

F#-A-C

```
Nte|F#---A----C----F#---F#---C----A----F#---
Deg|6----1----b3---6----6----b3---1----6----
  e|-----------------------------------------
  B|--------------7----7--------------------
  G|----------5-------------5----------------
  D|-----7-------------------------7---------
  A|9--------------------------------9----
  E|-----------------------------------------
```

vii dim - G#dim

G#-B-D

```
Nte|G#---B----D----G#---G#---D----B----G#---
Deg|7----2----4----7----7----4----2----7----
  e|-----------------------------------------
  B|--------------9----9--------------------
  G|----------7-------------7----------------
  D|-----9-------------------------9---------
  A|11-------------------------------11---
  E|-----------------------------------------
```

Standard tuning. Fixed key: A melodic minor. Classical and symmetric descending options are labeled separately.

Guitar Exercises - Section IX, Level 69

Module G - melodic-minor seventh-chord arpeggios

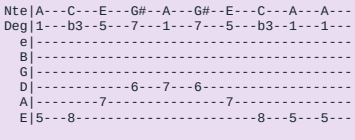
7 CHORDS | 70 TONES

TWO DOMINANT-SEVENTH CHORDS: IV7 AND V7

The melodic-minor seventh family contains AmMaj7, Bm7, Cmaj7#5, D7, E7, F#m7b5, and G#m7b5. Accent the quality-defining third, seventh, or flat fifth.

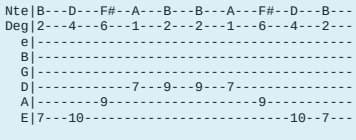
iMaj7 - AmMaj7

A-C-E-G#



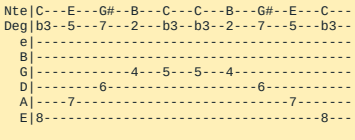
ii7 - Bm7

B-D-F#-A



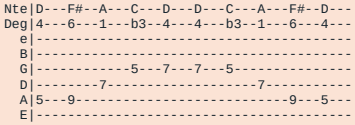
IIImaj7#5 - Cmaj7#5

C-E-G#-B



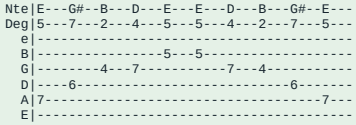
IV7 - D7

D-F#-A-C



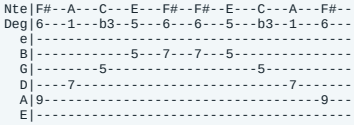
V7 - E7

E-G#-B-D



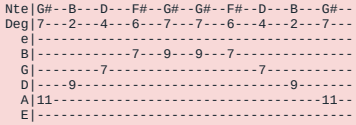
vi half-dim - F#m7b5

F#-A-C-E



vii half-dim - G#m7b5

G#-B-D-F#



Standard tuning. Fixed key: A melodic minor. Classical and symmetric descending options are labeled separately.

Guitar Exercises - Section IX, Level 69

Module I - progression-specific melodic-minor applications

2 PHRASES | 32 TONES

BEAT 1 IS A CHORD TONE; NOTES 2-4 MAY BE REPHRASED LATER

The first three phrases compare natural, harmonic, and melodic minor. The final two establish ii-V-i and an extended predominant chain unique to the melodic-minor chord family.

Natural-minor comparison | Am7 | Dm7 | Em7 | Am7 |

Four quarter notes per bar.

```
Nte|A---C---E---G---|D---F---A---C---|E---G---B---D---|A---C---E---G---|
Deg|1---b3--5---b7*-|4---b6*-1---b3--|5---b7*-2---4---|1---b3--5---b7*-|
Rol|>Am7Am7-Am7-Am7-|>Dm7Dm7-Dm7-Dm7-|>Em7Em7-Em7-Em7-|>Am7Am7-Am7-Am7-|
  e|----------------|----------------|----------------|----------------|
  B|----------------|----------------|----------------|--------5---8---|
  G|----------------|------------5---|------------7---|----5-----------|
  D|------------5---|--------7-------|--------9-------|7---------------|
  A|--------7-------|5---8-----------|7---10----------|----------------|
  E|5---8-----------|----------------|----------------|----------------|
```

AUDIT Identify the pitch or chord quality that separates this progression from the preceding minor form.

Harmonic-minor comparison | AmMaj7 | Dm7 | E7 | AmMaj7 |

Four quarter notes per bar.

```
Nte|A---C---E---G#--|D---F---A---C---|E---G#--B---D---|A---C---E---G#--|
Deg|1---b3--5---7---|4---b6*-1---b3--|5---7---2---4---|1---b3--5---7---|
Rol|>AmMAmMaAmMaAmMa|>Dm7Dm7-Dm7-Dm7-|>E7-E7--E7--E7--|>AmMAmMaAmMaAmMa|
  e|----------------|----------------|----------------|----------------|
  B|----------------|----------------|----------------|--------5---9---|
  G|----------------|------------5---|--------4---7---|----5-----------|
  D|------------6---|--------7-------|----6-----------|7---------------|
  A|--------7-------|5---8-----------|7---------------|----------------|
  E|5---8-----------|----------------|----------------|----------------|
```

AUDIT Identify the pitch or chord quality that separates this progression from the preceding minor form.

Guitar Exercises - Section IX, Level 69

Module I - progression-specific melodic-minor applications

2 PHRASES | 32 TONES

BEAT 1 IS A CHORD TONE; NOTES 2-4 MAY BE REPHRASED LATER

The first three phrases compare natural, harmonic, and melodic minor. The final two establish ii-V-i and an extended predominant chain unique to the melodic-minor chord family.

Melodic-minor identity | AmMaj7 | D7 | E7 | AmMaj7 |

Four quarter notes per bar.

```
Nte|A---C---E---G#--|D---F#--A---C---|E---G#--B---D---|A---C---E---G#--|
Deg|1---b3--5---7---|4---6---1---b3--|5---7---2---4---|1---b3--5---7---|
Rol|>AmMAmMaAmMaAmMa|>D7-D7--D7--D7--|>E7-E7--E7--E7--|>AmMAmMaAmMaAmMa|
  e|----------------|----------------|----------------|----------------|
  B|----------------|----------------|----------------|--------5---9---|
  G|----------------|------------5---|--------4---7---|----5-----------|
  D|------------6---|--------7-------|----6-----------|7---------------|
  A|--------7-------|5---9-----------|7---------------|----------------|
  E|5---8-----------|----------------|----------------|----------------|
```

AUDIT Identify the pitch or chord quality that separates this progression from the preceding minor form.

Functional ii-V-i | Bm7 | E7 | AmMaj7 | AmMaj7 |

Four quarter notes per bar.

```
Nte|B---D---F#--A---|E---G#--B---D---|A---C---E---G#--|A---C---E---G#--|
Deg|2---4---6---1---|5---7---2---4---|1---b3--5---7---|1---b3--5---7---|
Rol|>Bm7Bm7-Bm7-Bm7-|>E7-E7--E7--E7--|>AmMAmMaAmMaAmMa|>AmMAmMaAmMaAmMa|
  e|----------------|----------------|----------------|----------------|
  B|----------------|----------------|----------------|--------5---9---|
  G|----------------|--------4---7---|----------------|----5-----------|
  D|------------7---|----6-----------|------------6---|7---------------|
  A|--------9-------|7---------------|--------7-------|----------------|
  E|7---10----------|----------------|5---8-----------|----------------|
```

AUDIT Identify the pitch or chord quality that separates this progression from the preceding minor form.

Guitar Exercises - Section IX, Level 69

Module I - progression-specific melodic-minor applications

1 PHRASE | 16 TONES

BEAT 1 IS A CHORD TONE; NOTES 2-4 MAY BE REPHRASED LATER

The first three phrases compare natural, harmonic, and melodic minor. The final two establish ii-V-i and an extended predominant chain unique to the melodic-minor chord family.

Extended predominant chain | F#m7b5 | Bm7 | E7 | AmMaj7 |

Four quarter notes per bar.

```
Nte|F#--A---C---E---|B---D---F#--A---|E---G#--B---D---|A---C---E---G#--|
Deg|6---1---b3--5---|2---4---6---1---|5---7---2---4---|1---b3--5---7---|
Rol|>F#mF#m7F#m7F#m7|>Bm7Bm7-Bm7-Bm7-|>E7-E7--E7--E7--|>AmMAmMaAmMaAmMa|
  e|----------------|----------------|----------------|----------------|
  B|------------5---|----------------|----------------|--------5---9---|
  G|--------5-------|----------------|--------4---7---|----5-----------|
  D|----7-----------|------------7---|----6-----------|7---------------|
  A|9---------------|--------9-------|7---------------|----------------|
  E|----------------|7---10----------|----------------|----------------|
```

AUDIT Identify the pitch or chord quality that separates this progression from the preceding minor form.

Transformation passes

1. Keep beat 1 and change notes 2-4. 2. Convert the last three notes to shuffle eighths. 3. Use a symmetric melodic-minor descent. 4. Use a classical natural-minor descent only after the final tonic arrives. 5. Answer in a higher register.

Guitar Exercises - Section IX, Level 69

Module J - eight-bar melodic-minor model

8 BARS | 32 TONES

FOUR CHORD TONES PER BAR; THE NEW IV7 AND ii7 COLORS MUST BE AUDIBLE

Bars 1-4 state the primary iMaj7-IV7-V7-iMaj7 cadence. Bars 5-8 contrast Cmaj7#5 and Bm7 before returning through E7 to the tonic.

Bar 1 - AmMaj7

```
Nte|A---C---E---G#--|
Deg|1---b3--5---7---|
Rol|>AmMAmMaAmMaAmMa|
  D|------------6---|
  A|--------7-------|
  E|5---8-----------|
```

Bar 2 - D7

```
Nte|D---F#--A---C---|
Deg|4---6---1---b3--|
Rol|>D7-D7--D7--D7--|
  G|------------5---|
  D|--------7-------|
  A|5---9-----------|
```

Bar 3 - E7

```
Nte|E---G#--B---D---|
Deg|5---7---2---4---|
Rol|>E7-E7--E7--E7--|
  G|--------4---7---|
  D|----6-----------|
  A|7---------------|
```

Bar 4 - AmMaj7

```
Nte|A---C---E---G#--|
Deg|1---b3--5---7---|
Rol|>AmMAmMaAmMaAmMa|
  B|--------5---9---|
  G|----5-----------|
  D|7---------------|
```

Bar 5 - Cmaj7#5

```
Nte|C---E---G#--B---|
Deg|b3--5---7---2---|
Rol|>CmaCmajCmajCmaj|
  G|------------4---|
  D|--------6-------|
  A|----7-----------|
  E|8---------------|
```

Bar 6 - Bm7

```
Nte|B---D---F#--A---|
Deg|2---4---6---1---|
Rol|>Bm7Bm7-Bm7-Bm7-|
  D|------------7---|
  A|--------9-------|
  E|7---10----------|
```

Bar 7 - E7

```
Nte|E---G#--B---D---|
Deg|5---7---2---4---|
Rol|>E7-E7--E7--E7--|
  e|--------7---10--|
  B|5---9-----------|
```

Bar 8 - AmMaj7

```
Nte|A---C---E---G#--|
Deg|1---b3--5---7---|
Rol|>AmMAmMaAmMaAmMa|
  e|5---8-----------|
  B|--------5---9---|
```

SECOND PASS Add one slide or legato connection per bar without changing the four target attacks.

Standard tuning. Fixed key: A melodic minor. Classical and symmetric descending options are labeled separately.

Guitar Exercises - Section IX, Level 69

Module J - sixteen-bar melodic-minor capstone, bars 1-8

32 TONES | FOUR CHORD TONES PER BAR

THE TONIC COLOR CHANGES BETWEEN AmMaj7 AND Am6 WITHOUT LOSING A MINOR

Play the printed quarter-note pass first. On a second pass, preserve beat 1 and convert notes 2-4 into an eighth-note answer. Use the symmetric descending form unless a classical descent is specifically chosen.

Bar 1 - AmMaj7

```
Nte|A---C---E---G#--|
Deg|1---b3--5---7---|
Rol|>AmMAmMaAmMaAmMa|
  D|------------6---|
  A|--------7-------|
  E|5---8-----------|
```

Bar 2 - D7

```
Nte|D---F#--A---C---|
Deg|4---6---1---b3--|
Rol|>D7-D7--D7--D7--|
  G|------------5---|
  D|--------7-------|
  A|5---9-----------|
```

Bar 3 - E7

```
Nte|E---G#--B---D---|
Deg|5---7---2---4---|
Rol|>E7-E7--E7--E7--|
  G|--------4---7---|
  D|----6-----------|
  A|7---------------|
```

Bar 4 - AmMaj7

```
Nte|A---C---E---G#--|
Deg|1---b3--5---7---|
Rol|>AmMAmMaAmMaAmMa|
  B|--------5---9---|
  G|----5-----------|
  D|7---------------|
```

Bar 5 - Bm7

```
Nte|B---D---F#--A---|
Deg|2---4---6---1---|
Rol|>Bm7Bm7-Bm7-Bm7-|
  D|------------7---|
  A|--------9-------|
  E|7---10----------|
```

Bar 6 - E7

```
Nte|E---G#--B---D---|
Deg|5---7---2---4---|
Rol|>E7-E7--E7--E7--|
  G|--------4---7---|
  D|----6-----------|
  A|7---------------|
```

Bar 7 - AmMaj7

```
Nte|A---C---E---G#--|
Deg|1---b3--5---7---|
Rol|>AmMAmMaAmMaAmMa|
  D|------------6---|
  A|--------7-------|
  E|5---8-----------|
```

Bar 8 - Am6

```
Nte|A---C---E---F#--|
Deg|1---b3--5---6---|
Rol|>Am6Am6-Am6-Am6-|
  D|------------4---|
  A|--------7-------|
  E|5---8-----------|
```

Guitar Exercises - Section IX, Level 69

Module J - sixteen-bar melodic-minor capstone, bars 9-16

32 TONES | FOUR CHORD TONES PER BAR

THE TONIC COLOR CHANGES BETWEEN AmMaj7 AND Am6 WITHOUT LOSING A MINOR

Play the printed quarter-note pass first. On a second pass, preserve beat 1 and convert notes 2-4 into an eighth-note answer. Use the symmetric descending form unless a classical descent is specifically chosen.

Bar 9 - Cmaj7#5

```
Nte|C---E---G#--B---|
Deg|b3--5---7---2---|
Rol|>CmaCmajCmajCmaj|
  G|------------4---|
  D|--------6-------|
  A|----7-----------|
  E|8---------------|
```

Bar 10 - D7

```
Nte|D---F#--A---C---|
Deg|4---6---1---b3--|
Rol|>D7-D7--D7--D7--|
  G|------------5---|
  D|--------7-------|
  A|5---9-----------|
```

Bar 11 - F#m7b5

```
Nte|F#--A---C---E---|
Deg|6---1---b3--5---|
Rol|>F#mF#m7F#m7F#m7|
  B|------------5---|
  G|--------5-------|
  D|----7-----------|
  A|9---------------|
```

Bar 12 - E7

```
Nte|E---G#--B---D---|
Deg|5---7---2---4---|
Rol|>E7-E7--E7--E7--|
  e|--------7---10--|
  B|5---9-----------|
```

Bar 13 - G#m7b5

```
Nte|G#--B---D---F#--|
Deg|7---2---4---6---|
Rol|>G#mG#m7G#m7G#m7|
  B|------------7---|
  G|--------7-------|
  D|----9-----------|
  A|11--------------|
```

Bar 14 - E7

```
Nte|E---G#--B---D---|
Deg|5---7---2---4---|
Rol|>E7-E7--E7--E7--|
  e|--------7---10--|
  B|5---9-----------|
```

Bar 15 - AmMaj7

```
Nte|A---C---E---G#--|
Deg|1---b3--5---7---|
Rol|>AmMAmMaAmMaAmMa|
  e|5---8-----------|
  B|--------5---9---|
```

Bar 16 - Am6

```
Nte|A---C---E---F#--|
Deg|1---b3--5---6---|
Rol|>Am6Am6-Am6-Am6-|
  D|------------4---|
  A|--------7-------|
  E|5---8-----------|
```

ENDING Am6 closes the form with raised-sixth color; replace it with AmMaj7 for a tenser tonic close.

Guitar Exercises - Section IX, Level 69

Module J - recovery cards, ear tests, and directional decisions

12 CARDS | 24 TONES

PRESERVE THE PULSE; MOVE TO THE NEAREST SECURE CHORD TONE

The recovery cards resolve weak or outside notes without abandoning the form. The ear tests distinguish natural, harmonic, and melodic upper tetrachords and identify whether a descending line uses the symmetric or classical convention.

AmMaj7: D -> C

D -> C 11 -> b3

2 tones

AmMaj7: F# -> E

F# -> E 6 -> 5

2 tones

AmMaj7: B -> C

B -> C 9 -> b3

2 tones

D7: E -> F#

E -> F# 9 -> 3

2 tones

D7: G# -> A

G# -> A #11 -> 5

2 tones

D7: C# -> D

C# -> D M7 -> R

2 tones

E7: F# -> G#

F# -> G# 9 -> 3

2 tones

E7: A -> G#

A -> G# 11 -> 3

2 tones

E7: C -> B

C -> B b13 -> 5

2 tones

Bm7: C -> B

C -> B b9 -> R

2 tones

Cmaj7#5: D -> E

D -> E 9 -> 3

2 tones

F#m7b5: G# -> A

G# -> A 9 -> b3

2 tones

Ear tests

Identify E-F-G-A, E-F-G#-A, and E-F#-G#-A. Then identify whether a descent uses F#/G# or F/G.

Decision rule

Use symmetric melodic minor for a continuous modern color. Use the natural-minor descent when the line or style calls for the classical directional convention.

Standard tuning. Fixed key: A melodic minor. Classical and symmetric descending options are labeled separately.

Guitar Exercises - Section IX, Level 69

Melodic-minor improvisation laboratory

REUSE THE WRITTEN TARGETS; CHANGE ONE VARIABLE AT A TIME

THE SCALE FORM IS A CHOICE; THE CHORD TARGET AND BARLINE ARE FIXED

Use the progression | AmMaj7 | D7 | E7 | AmMaj7 |. The five passes below reuse the same beat-one target schedule and gradually reduce the written support.

Pass 1 - chord tones only	One root, third, fifth, or seventh per beat. No scale connectors.
Pass 2 - melodic-minor connectors	Add F# and G# as scale motion while preserving every target.
Pass 3 - symmetric descent	Use A melodic minor in both directions.
Pass 4 - classical descent	Ascend with F#/G#; descend with F/G after the tonic or phrase peak.
Pass 5 - tonic-color answer	Answer the final AmMaj7 phrase with Am6 or Am6/9 color.

STOP RULE If F/F# or G/G# changes without intention, return to one color pair and one bar.

Standard tuning. Fixed key: A melodic minor. Classical and symmetric descending options are labeled separately.

Guitar Exercises - Section IX, Level 69

Practice progression, error diagnosis, and workload audit

CONSTRUCTION BEFORE SPEED

REPAIR THE FIRST FAILED PITCH DECISION, NOT THE LAST WRONG NOTE

Ten-phase practice progression

1. Six upper-tetrachord comparisons.
2. Three octave routes and the two-octave mirror.
3. Three classical directional cells.
4. Six raised-sixth cells.
5. Six raised-seventh cells.
6. Seven triads and seven seventh chords.
7. Four tonic-color cells.
8. Five progression phrases.
9. Eight-bar model and sixteen-bar capstone.
10. Recovery cards and improvisation passes.

Error diagnosis

F LEAKS INTO ASCENT	isolate F-F#-G#-A
G LEAKS INTO SYMMETRIC DESCENT	reverse the melodic ascent slowly
CLASSICAL DESCENT SOUNDS FORCED	delay the switch until after the phrase peak
D7 SOUNDS LIKE Dm7	accent F# before C
Bm7 SOUNDS DIMINISHED	establish F# as the fifth
TONIC SOUNDS MAJOR	sustain C before G# or F# color
FORM LOSS	return to quarter-note chord tones

Written workload audit

A - three forms	72	**F - triads**	56	Advancement: add 2 BPM after three clean repetitions at the current route length. If the wrong sixth or seventh appears twice, reduce the route to one tetrachord before changing tempo.
B - octave routes	78	**G - sevenths**	70	
C - raised sixth	48	**H - tonic colors**	32	
D - raised seventh	36	**I - progressions**	80	
E - direction options	48	**J - model/capstone**	120	

TOTAL WRITTEN TONES: 640

Listening assignment

Record the natural, harmonic, and melodic upper tetrachords without announcing them. Identify them by ear the next day. Repeat with one symmetric and one classical descent.

Guitar Exercises - Section IX, Level 69

Section IX Level 69 mastery gate, completion audit, and practice log

NEXT: FIVE-POSITION MELODIC-MINOR MAP

ADVANCE AFTER TWO CLEAN DAYS WITH DELIBERATE SIXTH, SEVENTH, AND DESCENDING FORM

Mastery gate

- [ ] Spell A natural, harmonic, and melodic minor without reference.
- [ ] Play all octave routes with both pick starts.
- [ ] Play all raised-sixth and raised-seventh cells cleanly.
- [ ] Distinguish Am, AmMaj7, Am6, and Am6/9 colors.
- [ ] Distinguish their upper tetrachords by ear and on all six strings.
- [ ] Choose symmetric or classical descending forms intentionally.
- [ ] Spell and arpeggiate all seven triads and seventh chords.
- [ ] Perform all five progression phrases, the model, and the capstone.

Completion audit

- [ ] 6 form comparisons
- [ ] 3 directional cells
- [ ] 6 raised-7 cells
- [ ] 5 progressions
- [ ] 4 scale routes
- [ ] 6 raised-6 cells
- [ ] 14 arpeggio cells
- [ ] 16-bar capstone

Section direction

Level 69 establishes the pitch and harmony. Level 70 will map A melodic minor through five connected positions, horizontal lanes, seam transitions, grouped sequences, and full-register movement.

Practice log

Date	Module	Register / chord	D/U	BPM	Clean?	Wrong 6/7 or weak function	Next target

NEXT Level 70: A melodic minor five-position map, horizontal routes, seam transitions, and full-register movement.

Standard tuning. Fixed key: A melodic minor. Classical and symmetric descending options are labeled separately.